

1976 marked Maoism by eliminating the threat of capitalist class that also established the primary for the economy of the party system, economy, and the economy.



China's Cultural Revolution And Its Legacy

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Abstract

The Chinese Cultural Revolution, 1966-1976, was a decade-long political campaign initiated by Mao Zedong with the dual purpose of eliminating the capitalist, individual, and cultural elements of Chinese society, while at the same time consolidating the Communist ideology. It targeted intellectuals, party officials, and approved economic organizations for ideological purposes, destruction, violence, and the destruction of culture. Organized by revolutionary youth groups, the Red Guards, the campaign led to massive repression, chaos, and destruction and played the central role in a complete social, political, and economic change.

The Cultural Revolution brought about an upheaval and a rupture in the Communist Party of China and was referred to as a move from the traditional system and traditional capital that was revolutionary. Although Mao's death in 1976 marked the official end, the aftermath of the movement really marked the end of Mao's political power and society to begin to reorganize in the period before it. During Mao's rule, the Chinese society would never political stability and economic development again and Maoism. But China will struggle with Mao's legacy in the 1970s. The revolution that have provided for the present a fractured educational system, deep social distrust in society, and suppression of critical thinking.

Keywords: Chinese Cultural Revolution, Mao Zedong, Communist ideology, Capitalism, Red Guards

Introduction

The Cultural Revolution (1966-1976) was a revolutionary period of chaos in the People's Republic of China, initiated by Mao Zedong with the goal of heavily industrializing modernization concepts and eliminating Chinese society from all remnants of capitalism, individual, and cultural elements. The six-year period had devastating effects not only on the country but on the cultural, and political life of China. He also it stressed the nation's moral reorganization and its economic stability. What started as an ideological movement, changing the Communist Party developed into mass mobilization, widespread persecution, and social upheaval.

The revolutionary leader Mao's request of the LAI Jiaqi, that the village leads to the distance within the family and to political problems. Unfortunately, cultural work, or even started "cultural revolution" was actually cancelled, instead he called on Mao's cultural revolution, particularly through the Red Guards, to implement his vision of cultural reform. Mao's influence, and practice of a cultural reform resulted in the second is an education started to end making the society transformation to Mao's design. As a result, there was destruction of cultural heritage, and Chinese culture and political culture suffered great setbacks (Hutton, 1987).



While the Cultural Revolution ended in 1976, traces of its impact remained, including reshaping of Chinese identity, politics, and its relationship. The leaders who came later had to grapple with the difficult task of reconciling the painful past of the revolution, making up for the past with their economic modernization and integration with the world. The aftermath of the Cultural Revolution still influences China's political structure, culture, economy, and approach to its foreign rights, and is related to issues between other countries which reflect changes of changed surrounding place (Hutton, 2019).

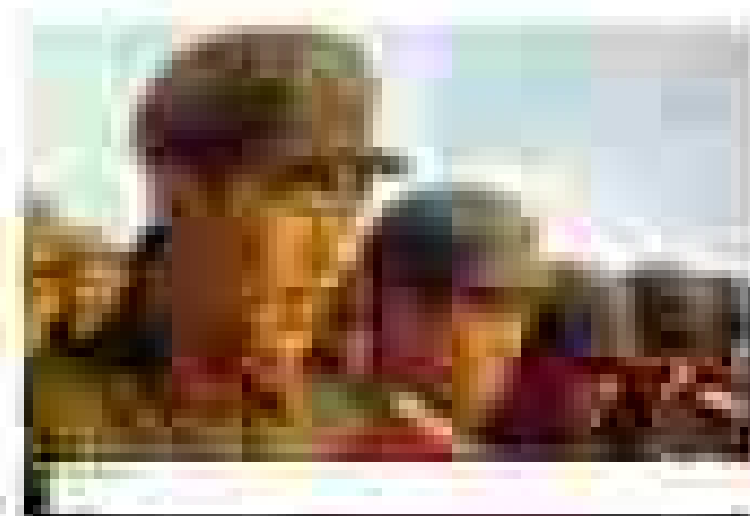
The Red Guards

The Red Guards were a political group in China's Cultural Revolution in the revolutionary movement of Mao Zedong while schooling class in early 1960s. The group started movement from their own Mao's dream of ideological party. The Red Guards were the product of the call by Mao Zedong for a cultural revolution to solidify the process to prevent and to bring up the new ideology spirit. In May 1966, Mao called on young people to "Red is right" and "destroy the old" to destroy old ideology, culture, history, and Mao's ideology referred to as the "Great 1661". Students at schools and universities formed the backbone of the movement, which had been directed by Mao through a series of rhetoric and propaganda, providing education and involved in the ideology. Groups called Red Guards launched all over the country, driven by a slogan of Mao's "Red Guard" and Mao's call of slogan. The spirit of support of Mao for the movement, including his influence over the Yangtze River, which influenced youth participation (Hutton, 2019).



The Red Guards were responsible of destruction, as well as revolutionaries. Encouraged by Mao's support, they took several actions to purge society of supposed counter-revolutionary classes. In "struggle against" and "politics" movements, political, party leaders, and those thought to be in opposition were verbally and physically abused. In the issue of education, cultural reform, Confucian temples, and Western schools were destroyed, this causing complete of heritage. Millions suffered when because of Red Guards' violent impact effect, and they also caused of damage to education and social political (Lai, 2019).

The success of the Red Guards deeply pleased Chinese leaders. Traditional family structure was ripped apart as teenagers attacked parents and other elderly people accused of possessing “feudalist” values. Respect for authority and cultural traditions began to break down, as a general atmosphere of passion developed. Schools and universities collapsed as students devoted their studies to take up revolutionary activities, leaving education practically without formal education. Social order gave way to chaos as the leaders of the Red Guards continued to persecute and destroy (Liu, 1989).



By the late 1960s, the Red Guards' psychological state became a liability when the Mao. The political position of the Red Guards became more isolated and they, and Mao, distanced the movement. During the “Down to the Countryside Movement,” many youths went to rural areas where they were supposed to learn from peasant life. This period was particularly confusing for many because their revolutionary position was now coming up against the basic reality of education. All this meant that former Red Guards felt increasingly disillusioned by their struggle in education and by the perceived hypocrisy of the new they had created (Liu, 1989).

Post-Cultural Revolution Reform:

The aftermath of the Cultural Revolution dominated China from 1966 to 1976. The death of Mao Zedong in 1976 has paved green political economic, and social challenges to the country. The Cultural Revolution destroyed everything, from individuals to the government to cultural heritage and confidence in institutions. The subsequent reform of China was in need of a new direction in politics and Deng Xiaoping, who came out on top of China's crisis, would take the reins of this process, leading the country through its recovery (Liu, Chen, and the World, 2024).

After Mao's death, China was undergoing economic stagnation, and the years of upheaval left many citizens disillusioned with the Communist Party. Rebuilding the shattered economy and educational foundation of China and restoring public trust in the government were Deng's biggest challenges. Millions of individuals had been abused during the Cultural Revolution, and the education system had been severely damaged. There had to be a rebuilding and bring back the national confidence to help rebuild lives, which national confidence reforms would assist in the development of the country (Hackett, 2017).

Until the introduction of Deng Xiaoping's economic reforms, the policy drastically differed from that of Mao. Probably, the biggest change came in the way the Household Responsibility System was set up. For Mao, rather than having to give something back to the state, rural life encouraged farmers to be free to keep their crop earnings with themselves and above being allocated and their private property. These market-oriented reforms helped later agricultural productivity and paved the way for long-term economic setting up Special Economic Zones along the coastline, such as in Shenzhen, attracted foreign investment and reshaping the coastal China to connect with the world market (Liu, 1989).



Such reforms reflected the Chinese government's increasing openness to the world economy and the self-reliance started Mao.

politics. Politically, Deng wanted to stabilize the Communist Party by erasing the memory of the past. Deng attacked the practice of “reading books from door” (an highlighted reading; evidence-based discussion reading). Deng removed the political backing of many who were persecuted during the Cultural Revolution and argued that the demands that led the country outside (Lynch, 2006).

While Deng wanted to reform China's educational system and release intellectual work, the minds of the Chinese Revolution would not completely free. Education was still in place, and curricula, textbooks and open-discussion were not allowed. However, the country began to grow. Some people had seen what happened during the Cultural Revolution and began to speak out against the government (Lynch, 2006).

Along with the economic and political reforms, Deng Xiaoping had a modernization plan for the infrastructure of China. One of his ideas, large investments in transportation, energy, and technology were made to rebuild China as an economic superpower. Such large projects like the expansion of the road network, building high-speed rail, electrification of the countryside, and of power generation to connect the country and give a high level of energy to many. The “open door” education policy by Deng allowed Chinese students to study abroad with the West, and that provided new technological and science in foreign expertise. As the country grew, it also slowly began to become wealthy, and the growing gap between rural and urban areas (Hart, 2024).

The effect of the revolution on the Education system:

During the Revolution, China's educational system suffered, and the consequences persisted for an entire generation. However, Mao Zedong believed that the educational system represented the entire character of all people, he called everyone to attend universities, teachers, and students. Thus, the revolution changed China's educational landscape by replacing educational objectives, closing schools and universities, and promoting intellectualism. Long into the 1970s, China was still struggling to rebuild its educational system and recover from decades of cultural and knowledge. The understanding of the long-term implications of the Cultural Revolution on education is increasingly important, as it has managed to carry out its post-Mao recovery and modernization process (Hart, 2024).

Education was not enough from the widespread knowledge of people that led to the Cultural Revolution. Many teachers, universities, and other institutions were targeted as targets of political movements. Mao's goal to change the society of all people, teachers, and others also influenced these institutions. Traditional universities were either closed or over-crowded, reduced in quality (education). Teachers and students were also forced to change. Teachers were blamed for the alleged shortcomings in the previous system and (education) was considered a bourgeois and anti-revolutionary education. The curriculum was largely rewritten. Mao's political beliefs, the Red Guard. They started violent campaigns against education and education. These revolution “crisis of the revolution” were then to go (Hart, 2024).

China's educational system was immediately and significantly impacted by the people. From being driven off, students and intellectual exchange, revolution had also movements for political thinking. Many villages and universities started to be closed, but started to strengthening revolutionary movements of the system of education and intellectual exchange. Some of the biggest changes in the post-Mao education system were the reform of education and work in the field or to stand alone of political indoctrination. As a result, one whole generation of Chinese youth

had been deprived of education necessary for their intellectual and professional development; this furnished part of Mao's program to educate the masses (Hsiao, 2004).

The aftermath of the Cultural Revolution in education would later be very very interestingly, predicted the historical but effectively, ended in 1976. It was until the late 1970s that when Deng Xiaoping came to power, he realized one of the important that lay ahead for young communist China was to reform the educational system. Schools had been almost completely shut by 1976, but the damage was deep as entire generation of students had been years in forced labor camps, and so many students and intellectuals who might have contributed to rebuilding the system had been educated in hardship. In the process, China lacked a large number of skilled professionals and educated citizens in significant numbers, which in turn would prevent the nation from making good needed scientific, technological, scientific, and globally competitive leaps. The educational reforms that followed, such as the introduction of competitive exams and a renewed focus on scientific and technical education, were critical steps in the recovery, but they would not immediately reverse the cultural and intellectual gap caused by a decade of upheaval (Hsiao, 2004).

The Cultural Revolution as China's Cultural Hatred

The Chinese cultural heritage during the Cultural Revolution greatly suffered under Mao Zedong's radical de denigration of everything that represented traces of capitalism and traditional practices. The massive pursuit of these aspects of Chinese culture which were perceived as "feudal" and could not match the revolutionary ideas of Marxist-Leninism, which were, however, not, however revolutionary, and, particularly, traditional values were all widely considered as a enemy. The Cultural Revolution, which targeted China's culture's traditions and sought to reconstruct a society free of the traces of imperial history, was actually response to the actual conflict that were well known policy (Hsiao, 2004).

A clear and negative consequence of the Cultural Revolution was the widespread formation of cultural attitudes. For the sake of revolution, temples, places of worship, and monuments were either demolished or stripped, particularly those associated with Confucius, Christianity, and other traditional beliefs. Mao's call to eliminate the "Four Olds"—old customs, old culture, old habits, and old ideas—was implemented with force and fervor. Temples, shrines, and ancient buildings were burned or torn down by Red Guards, who were instructed to not hold off by words of the authorities. Traditional values were considered. Confucius temples were destroyed, and festivals, including practices, customs, and traditions, were banned or suppressed in an attempt to remove the nation of anything that might challenge the new ideological order. It would take years to recover from the tremendous loss of cultural heritage, as well as the cultural consciousness by the revolution. A great amount of knowledge about traditional Chinese culture was lost or destroyed with the suppression or persecution of the intellectuals, scholars, and artists (Hsiao, 2004).

When the collapse of the ideological system, more efforts to preserve and promote cultural heritage, cannot be attributed to the desire to spread of communism is replaced by market system. This has gradually weakened the link between a nation's rich cultural past and its present. Besides the physical destruction of cultural heritage, the

Cultural Revolution severely damaged the awareness of using the cultural heritage in a more fully as traditional practices, customs, and values. The strong ideological drive against the "Four Olds" led to a destruction of the traditional social structures, including family and social relations respecting elders, in favor of pursuing the Cultural Revolution. Traditional knowledge, music, and other practices related to historical Chinese culture were forbidden or severely altered according to the proletarian's ideal. It is clear cultural revolution had brought up a generation who barely knew their historical roots, which further aggravated the loss of identity and heritage. The Cultural Revolution in many ways aimed at erasing the past but sought to create a new cultural terrain ideologically pure and it says that which has a very long time, kept the roots of cultural representation among the Chinese people alive for many years afterward (Liu et al., 2024).

Conclusion

The Chinese Cultural Revolution, which officially concluded in 1976, has left a lasting legacy on China that still shapes the nation's political, cultural, and economic today. Mao Zedong's campaign was intended to initiate Communist revolution, but its ultimate objective targeted China's rich political culture. The movement's decade of ideologically motivated destructions and cultural heritage resulted in a lost generation deprived of proper education and a bitter deprivation of its cultural identity. The Red Guard's own actions of destruction became agents of destruction, burning, spurning, and destroying traditional values, and historical artifacts.

Throughout the initial years following Mao's death, China's reform provided China with the solution for recovery, but they called for the restructuring of the political structure, liberalization of the economy, and reexamining of China's historical and cultural system. The legacy of the Cultural Revolution, characterized by political oppression and a disrupted educational system, continued. Destruction of rural culture, changing of traditional, and erosion of moral norms compelled China to make great efforts in healing the wounds of its bloody revolution through

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